



How to respond to a bad guest review: 12 replies you can copy (2026)

Last checked 5 October 2026. Fill in the [BRACKETS] with your own facts.

Four common complaints

A cleanliness complaint

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for staying and for telling us about [WHAT THEY SAID WAS GOOD]. I am sorry the [ROOM OR ITEM] was not clean when you arrived. [ADD IF TRUE: I have changed how we check the [ROOM OR ITEM] between stays.] If anything is not right in future, message me during your stay so I can fix it at once.

A noise complaint

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for your review. I am sorry the noise from [SOURCE] disturbed your sleep. The listing says [WHAT THE LISTING SAYS ABOUT NOISE], and I will make it clearer. [ADD IF TRUE: We have now put in [WHAT YOU DID].] I hope the rest of your stay was comfortable.

It did not match the photos

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for the honest feedback. I am sorry that [WHAT DID NOT MATCH] was not what you expected from the photos. [ADD IF TRUE: I have updated the listing so it shows [WHAT YOU CHANGED].] I appreciate you taking the time to tell other guests.

A mixed review

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for staying and for the kind words about [WHAT THEY LIKED]. I am sorry about [THE ONE COMPLAINT]. [ADD IF TRUE: WHAT YOU WILL DO ABOUT IT.] We would be glad to host you again.

When something broke

The hot water or heating stopped

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for staying and for telling us about this. I am sorry the [HOT WATER OR HEATING] stopped working on [DAY]. [WHAT YOU DID, FOR EXAMPLE SENT AN ENGINEER THE SAME DAY.] [ADD IF TRUE: It has been repaired and I have checked it since.] I hope the rest of the stay was comfortable.

The wifi was slow or down

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for your review. I am sorry the wifi was [SLOW OR DOWN] during your stay. The listing says [WHAT THE LISTING SAYS ABOUT WIFI]. [ADD IF TRUE: I have asked [PROVIDER] to fix it and I have put the speed I measured, [SPEED], in the listing.] I hope it did not spoil the trip.

An item or appliance did not work

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for the review. I am sorry the [ITEM] did not work. I should have tested it before you arrived. [ADD IF TRUE: I have [REPAIRED OR REPLACED] it, and

I now test it at every changeover.] Thank you for the kind words about [WHAT THEY SAID WAS GOOD].

Check-in and messages

Check-in went wrong

Hi [GUEST NAME], I am sorry your arrival on [DAY] was stressful. [WHAT WENT WRONG, FOR EXAMPLE THE LOCKBOX CODE DID NOT WORK.] That should not have happened. [ADD IF TRUE: The check-in message now includes [WHAT YOU ADDED], and I have a back-up plan if the code fails.] Thank you for staying with us.

I was slow to reply

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for your review. I am sorry I was slow to answer your messages on [DAY]. [ONE LINE OF THE REAL REASON, ONLY IF YOU WANT TO GIVE IT.] [ADD IF TRUE: I now check messages at [TIMES], and [NAME] covers for me when I cannot.] I am glad [WHAT THEY SAID WAS GOOD].

Reviews that are hard to answer

One star and no text

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for staying. I am sorry the stay did not go well for you. The review does not say what went wrong, and I would like to know. If you are happy to message me, I will read it carefully. [ADD IF TRUE: Other guests' feedback has led me to change [WHAT YOU CHANGED].]

The review gets a fact wrong

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for your review. I would like to put one detail right for guests who read it: [THE FACT, FOR EXAMPLE THE LISTING SAYS PARKING IS A 5 MINUTE WALK AWAY]. I am sorry if that was not clear enough. [ADD IF TRUE: I have made it clearer in the listing.] I hope you enjoyed the rest of your trip.

A house rule was not followed

Hi [GUEST NAME], thank you for your review. The house rules, shown in the listing before booking, say [THE RULE, IN THE LISTING'S OWN WORDS]. I am sorry the stay did not feel as you expected. I wish you well with your next trip.

<https://proskillpacks.github.io/hosts/how-to-respond-to-a-bad-guest-review/>

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The full version: Host Ops Pack. Six skills for the listing, review and house-rules jobs of hosts who run their own listings.

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